

# Day 7 — Sāyana vs Nirayana

**Module:** Movement of the Sun (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

## Goal

Distinguish tropical and sidereal zodiacs; introduce ayanāṁśa.

## Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

## The flow

### Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

### Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

### Today's idea (10 min)

- *nirayana* (IAST: nirayana; lit. “sidereal zodiac (linked to fixed stars)”)
- There are TWO ways to measure the Sun's path:
  - **Sāyana** (modern science): starts at the Vernal Equinox (Mar 21).
  - **Nirayana** (Indian tradition): starts at a fixed star.

These two ways DRIFT apart slowly — about  $1^\circ$  every 70 years. Over many centuries, they're now ~24 days apart.

Children draw two suns: one labelled “tradition” and one labelled “modern.” They're at slightly different spots.

### Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sunrise Direction Tracking* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

### Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

## Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

## Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.